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Software Development Engineer in Test

Driver and Vehicle Licensing Agency

Apply before 11:55 pm on Sunday 11th October 2026



Reference number

478847

Salary

£39,163

The salary of £39,163 (basic salary £35,663) includes a non-pensionable Recruitment and Retention Allowance of £3,500.

Job grade

Higher Executive Officer

Contract type

Permanent

Business area

DVLA - Information Technology Services

Type of role

Digital
Information Technology

Working pattern

Flexible working, Full-time, Job share, Part-time

Number of jobs available

2

Contents

[Location](#)

[About the job](#)

[Benefits](#)

[Things you need to know](#)

[Apply and further information](#)

Location

Swansea

About the job

Job summary

Do you have experience of automation development and Continuous Integration?

Would you like to work with leading serverless and cloud-based technologies?

If so, we'd love to hear from you!

Joining our department comes with many benefits, including:

Employer pension contribution of 28.97% of your salary. Read more about Civil Service Pensions [here](#)

25 days annual leave, increasing by 1 day each year of service (up to a maximum of 30 days annual leave), plus 8 bank holidays and a privilege day for the King's birthday

Flexible working options where we encourage a great work-life balance.

Read more in the Benefits section below!

Find out more about what it's like working at DVLA - [Driver and Vehicle Licensing Agency](#) [Civil Service Careers](#)

Job description

At the Driver and Vehicle Licensing Agency (DVLA), we take testing very seriously and we automate as much as we can. Our Software Development Engineer in Test (SDETs) are building best-in-class test automation software so that we can build products quickly and safely.

We will look to you to build and execute test automation for our brand new or newly transformed services. You will be a critical part of a squad following a behaviour-driven design approach (ATDD) making sure our software is tested and testable and continually driving all aspects of quality improvements.

This is a fantastic opportunity to build upon your skills and experience while helping to build world class digital services that pave the way for future business transformation. If you love to test and code and want to work with cutting edge cloud-first technologies, we encourage you to apply.

Your responsibilities will include, but aren't limited to:

- Developing and executing test automated frameworks.

- Working in an agile environment with product development teams.

- Ensuring good engineering practices and knowledge sharing within your team.

- Working closely with business analysts and agile delivery managers to prepare and review user stories and tasks.

- Helping ensure that our services are resilient and supported.

For further information on the role, please read the attached role profile. Please note that the role profile is for information purposes only - whilst all elements are relevant to the role, they may not all be assessed during the recruitment process. This job advert will detail exactly what will be assessed during the recruitment process.

Open Sessions: Would you like to find out more about the role, the team and what it's like to work in our department? If so, we are organising an open session where you can virtually 'meet the team' on Tuesday 6th October at 12:30pm. Sign up [here](#).

Person specification

Required experience:

To be successful in this role you will need to have the following experience:

We are looking for experienced developers who are proficient in Automation Testing, able to use modern programming language and to programmatically test any software product and develop automation for it.

You will have experience of improving QA efficiency through test automation and tools and will proactively look to implement Continuous Testing

principles to speed up the feedback cycle for all elements of quality using automation by default.

You will have a high attention to detail and not be afraid to challenge when required and will enjoy working as part of a team in a fast-paced Agile delivery environment.

Working for the DVLA Digital Team

At DVLA, licensing is just the start. Every project you implement, touch and deliver has a ripple effect that ll wash across the nation. Here the work you re doing has the capacity to change the way 53 million people interact with our services. As we aim to keep our roads some of the safest in the world, our innovative, transformative digital-led services help optimise a nation of individuals and business every single day.

To see how our people are transforming our digital services, head over to our [DVLA Digital Services Blog](#) and, to understand more about the great opportunities and benefits of working at DVLA read our [Inside DVLA blog](#).

Working hours, office attendance and travel requirements

Full time roles consist of 37 hours per week. Whilst we welcome applications from those looking to work with us on a part time basis, there is a business requirement for the successful candidate to be able to work at least **35** hours per week.

This role **is suitable** for hybrid working, which is a non-contractual arrangement where a combination of workplace and home-based working can be accommodated subject to business requirements.

The expectation at present is a minimum of **60%** of your working time a month will be spent at either your designated workplace (one of the locations cited in the advert) or, when required for business reasons, in another office/ work location. There may be occasions where you are required to attend above the minimum expectation.

If you have a question about hybrid working, part time/job share hours, flexible working, travelling for work, or require a reasonable adjustment, please contact the Vacancy Holder during the recruitment process to avoid possible disappointment later in the process should your working

arrangements not be compatible with the requirements of the role (see below for contact details).

Security Check

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is security check. To allow for meaningful checks to be carried out, candidates will be required to have at least 5 years continuous residency in the UK. All applicants for this role must ensure that they meet this minimum residency requirement - if you do not, your application will be withdrawn.

Visa Sponsorship

Please note that we do not hold a UK Visa & Immigration (UKVI) Skilled Worker Licence sponsor and are unable to sponsor any individuals for Skilled Worker Sponsorship. Candidates must ensure they have the appropriate rights to work in the UK before application.

Behaviours

We'll assess you against these behaviours during the selection process:

Working Together

Technical skills

We'll assess you against these technical skills during the selection process:

Modern Development Standards (Practitioner)

Programming and build (software engineering) (Practitioner)

Benefits

Passionate, reliable and always willing to push yourself and those around you, you'll continue to seek improvement in your own role and challenge us too. Because we pride ourselves on how we approach your development. From training courses to specialist skills workshops and opportunities to grow your

expertise, we thrive when you thrive. You can find out more about all of the above [here](#) alongside a full list of our benefits:

Best in class learning and development tailored to your role

An environment with flexible working options where we encourage a great work-life balance

A culture encouraging inclusion and diversity with a range of staff communities to support all our colleagues

Generous employer contribution of 28.9%, depending on chosen [pension scheme](#)

Flexible working options where we encourage a great work-life balance.

Digital communities with clear career frameworks

On-site gym plus personal training available (membership applies)

On-site nursery, restaurants and coffee bar

25 days holiday (plus bank holidays), increasing by 1 each year (up to 30) & 8 Bank Holidays plus an additional Privilege Day to mark the King's birthday.

24-hour Employee Assistance Programme providing free confidential help and advice for staff.

Free parking

Find out more about [the benefits of working at DfT and its agencies](#) (opens in a new window).

Things you need to know

Artificial intelligence

Artificial intelligence can be a useful tool to support your application, however, all examples and statements provided must be truthful, factually accurate and taken directly from your own experience. Where plagiarism has been identified (presenting the ideas and experiences of others, or generated by artificial intelligence, as your own) applications may be withdrawn and internal candidates may be subject to disciplinary action. Please see our [candidate guidance \(opens in a new window\)](#) for more information on appropriate and inappropriate use.

Selection process details

This vacancy is using [Success Profiles \(opens in a new window\)](#), and will assess your Behaviours, Experience and Technical skills.

Our selection process ensures a comprehensive assessment of each applicant's qualifications, skills, and potential fit within our organisation.

The selection process for this role will be:

Stage 1: Sift of CV by Inspire People (our recruitment Partners)

Stage 2: Sift of CV by DVLA panel

Stage 3: Coding Exercise

Stage 4: Interview

You must be successful at each stage to progress to the next stage.

Stage 1: Sift by Inspire People

As part of the application process, you will be asked to provide a CV to Inspire People (our Recruitment Partners) which outlines your experience and suitability for the role (based on the experience points outlined in the essential criteria on this advert).

Please note; the sift will be completed on a rolling basis whilst the campaign is still live and so there is potential for feedback to be shared with you (on your application) before the advert closes.

To apply please click 'Apply at advertiser's site' at the bottom of the page.

At sift, you will be assessed against the following Success Profile elements:

Experience you will be asked to provide a CV (unlimited wordcount). Please provide evidence of your Experience of the following:

- Experience using modern programming languages

- Demonstrable experience of automation in all aspects of test

- Practical experience of CI (Continuous Integration)

Should we receive a high volume of quality applications, we may invite a shortlist of the highest scoring candidates to interview. This means that some applications that meet the required standard could be placed on hold after the sift and invited to interview if the vacant position(s) remain unfilled. You will be notified if your application is being put on hold once the sift has been completed. Following interviews, any applicants remaining on hold will be notified by the panel of the next steps regarding their application.

Stage 2: Sift by DVLA panel

If successful through sift by Inspire People your CV and personal statement will then be sifted by a panel at DVLA

This sift will take place w/c 12/10//2026.

Stage 3: Coding Exercise

If at sift your application is successful through sift by the DVLA panel, you will be invited to the first stage of the interview process where you will be asked to complete a Coding exercise. Guidance will be provided if you are successful at stage 2.

The coding exercise will take place week commencing 26/10/2026.

If you are successful at this stage, you will be invited to a final stage interview.

Stage 4: Interview

At interview stage, you will be assessed against the following Success Profile elements:

Experience

Behaviours Working Together

Technical

Modern Development Standards (Practitioner)

Programming and build (software engineering) (Practitioner)

The interviews will take place week commencing 02/11/2026.

This interview will be conducted in person at our DVLA Swansea office, Longview Road, Morriston, Swansea, SA67JL.

Please note that the technical elements of the role will be assessed against Government Digital and Data Profession Capability Framework (Skills) which you will be able to access [here](#).

You can find out more about [our hiring process, how to apply, and application and interview guidance on our careers site](#) (opens in a new window).

Please note that we will try to meet the dates set out in the advert. There may be occasions when these dates will change.

Further information on the selection process

Feedback on your application can only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

We will also hold a 12-month reserve list for this role, which may lead to potential opportunities beyond the role you applied for.

Feedback will only be provided if you attend an interview or assessment.

Security

Successful candidates must undergo a basic (or equivalent) criminal record check.

Successful candidates must meet the security requirements before they can be appointed. The level of security needed is [security check](#) (opens in a new window).

[See our vetting charter](#) (opens in a new window).

People working with government assets must complete [baseline personnel security standard](#) (opens in new window) checks.

Nationality requirements

This job is broadly open to the following groups:

UK nationals

nationals of the Republic of Ireland

nationals of Commonwealth countries who have the right to work in the UK

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities with settled or pre-settled status under the [European Union Settlement Scheme \(EUSS\) \(opens in a new window\)](#)

nationals of the EU, Switzerland, Norway, Iceland or Liechtenstein and family members of those nationalities who have made a valid application for settled or pre-settled status under the European Union Settlement Scheme (EUSS)

individuals with limited leave to remain or indefinite leave to remain who were eligible to apply for EUSS on or before 31 December 2020

Turkish nationals, and certain family members of Turkish nationals, who have accrued the right to work in the Civil Service

[Further information on nationality requirements \(opens in a new window\)](#)

Working for the Civil Service

The [Civil Service Code \(opens in a new window\)](#) sets out the standards of behaviour expected of civil servants.

We recruit by merit on the basis of fair and open competition, as outlined in the Civil Service Commission's [recruitment principles \(opens in a new window\)](#).

The Civil Service embraces diversity and promotes equal opportunities. As such, we run a Disability Confident Scheme (DCS) for candidates with disabilities who meet the minimum selection criteria.

Diversity and Inclusion

The Civil Service is committed to attract, retain and invest in talent wherever it is found. To learn more please see the [Civil Service People Plan \(opens in a new window\)](#) and the [Civil Service Diversity and Inclusion Strategy \(opens in a new window\)](#).

Apply and further information

This vacancy is part of the [Great Place to Work for Veterans \(opens in a new window\)](#) initiative.

The Civil Service welcomes applications from people who have recently left prison or have an unspent conviction. [Read more about prison leaver recruitment \(opens in new window\)](#).

Once this job has closed, the job advert will no longer be available. You may want to save a copy for your records.

Contact point for applicants

Job contact :

Name : Andrew Medhurst

Email : Amedhurst@inspirepeople.net

Recruitment team

Email : dftrecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk

Further information

If you feel your application has not been treated in accordance with the Recruitment Principles and you wish to make a complaint, in the first instance, you should contact Government Recruitment Services via email: dftrecruitment.grs@cabinetoffice.gov.uk If you are not satisfied with the response you receive from the Department, you can contact the Civil Service Commission: Click here (<https://civilservicecommission.independent.gov.uk/>) to visit Civil Service Commission

Civil Service
Commission

